

RDTII Data Collection Hands-on Practice Assignment

Practice exercise for understanding data collection in real research settings and improving regulatory analysis workflow.

Assignment submission	Indicators	Deadline
Completed Excel dataset < [5th June] RDTII 2.1 data collection practice assignment > Via email attachment to escap-digitaltrade-hackathon@un.org	Required - Indicator 6.1 Singapore - Indicator 7.3 Malaysia Optional - Indicator 5.3 optional	Tuesday, 9 June

Please Read First

This exercise is intended to help participants understand how RDTII researchers conduct fully manual data collection. To ensure the exercise serves its intended purpose, please **do not use AI tools**. Submissions that contain **clear signs of AI-generated** content will **not receive feedback**.

Objective

This assignment is intended to help participants better understand how **RDTII data collection works in real research settings**, and to support the development of more effective tools for regulatory analysis.

This exercise is **not part of the mandatory submission agenda**, and submission **will not affect the final overall score or ranking of any team**.

Recommended Research Approach

For each case, follow the general workflow:

- Identify the correct indicator and its scope
- Identify the correct source (primary, official, enforced)
- Conduct structured extraction and interpretation
- Classify the measure according to the indicator logic
- Record the result in the database fields (see “**RDTII data collection practice format requirements**” for formality requirements)

Indicator 6.1 — Singapore

This case is designed to help you understand the boundary between Indicator 6.1 and Indicator 6.4.

- Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 6.1 captures a ban on cross-border data transfer and/or a local processing requirement. It does not cover every rule that merely imposes conditions on data transfer.
- Identify the relevant source families:** Do not look only at the general data protection law. You should also consider whether relevant sectoral laws or regulations exist.

- **Extract the operative legal text and explain it:** If the law allows transfer subject to conditions such as comparable protection, consent, contractual safeguards, or approval, the provision is more likely to fall under Indicator 6.4 rather than Indicator 6.1.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the legal source, scope, relevant provision, explanation, timeframe, and references.
- **Key lesson:** Do not miscode a transfer-limitation obligation as a ban, clearly distinguish the indicator scope.

Indicator 7.3 — Malaysia

This case is designed to help you understand the distinction between a minimum retention requirement and a retention-limitation principle.

- **Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 7.3 captures rules that require data to be retained for at least a specified minimum period.
- **Start with the general law, but do not stop there:** You should first review the general privacy or data protection framework, but also check whether there are relevant sector-specific laws or regulations.
- **Extract the operative text and interpret it carefully:** A rule stating that data must not be kept longer than necessary is not the same as a rule requiring data to be retained for a minimum period.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the legal source, scope, relevant provision, explanation, timeframe, and references.

***Key takeaway:** A general privacy law may only be the starting point. The decisive retention rule may appear in a sectoral or technical instrument. One indicator may include multiple horizontal and sectoral legal sources.*

Indicator 5.3 — India (Optional)

This optional case is designed to help you understand how to work with a practice-oriented indicator, where both primary legal sources and factual materials may matter.

***Key lesson:** The question is not simply whether there is a law, but what the official evidence of government ownership in telecom companies is.*

- **Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 5.3 asks whether the Government owns shares in telecom companies, and whether the ownership threshold is met.
- **Identify the evidence base:** Primary sources may include official Government or regulator materials. Factual or supporting materials may include annual reports, official company websites, and official ownership records.
- **Extract and explain the relevant information:** Clearly identify the company name, ownership percentage, source of that information, and the relevant timeframe.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the evidence and explain why it is relevant to the indicator.

***Key takeaway:** Some indicators cannot be completed by relying on a single legal provision alone. They require a combination of legal analysis and factual verification.*

****Inserting format for improved readability: see “RDTII data collection practice format requirements” for formality requirements.***